

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6
 ♥ Q J 10 7 3
 ♦ 10 5 3
 ♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ A 6 5
 ♦ K J
 ♣ K Q 10 9 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 3
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ 9 7 6 2
 ♣ A 5

♠ A 10 4
 ♥ K 9 8
 ♦ A Q 8 4
 ♣ J 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♠	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

Lead: ♠7

♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠7, the suit your partner overcalled.

If partner had not overcalled, the ♥Q would be the perfect lead against 3NT. But partner DID overcall, perhaps to give you a hint on what to lead if South became declarer.

As you see, a ♠ lead will defeat the contract this time while the ♥Q would let declarer make 11 tricks.

Consider this: even if partner has a high ♥ to help you establish the suit it is not very likely that you would be able to get the lead with your entryless hand.

There is another, more subtle, reason for leading partner's suit. If the lead turns out wrong, and the ♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5

♠ 6 5 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ 9 4 2



♠ K 7

♥ 8 6 4

♦ J 7 2

♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3

♥ K J

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A 7 6 3

West

North

East

South

1♣

Dbl

All Pass

1♣X by South

Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 1♣
doubled

Lead the ♣5.

There is only one reason partner would pass your
takeout double - he has a great ♣ suit and he expects
to inflict a large penalty.

What he wants do do is pull South's trumps so your
high card winners don't get ruffed by South. The way
you can help him do that is to start with a trump lead.

With the trump lead South might not make more than
three tricks.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 6
 ♥ 9 8 5 2
 ♦ 9 7 5
 ♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 6 4

♦ K Q 10 3

♣ 7 4 2



♠ 8 7 5 4 3

♥ Q 10 3

♦ A 4

♣ J 10 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A J 7

♦ J 8 6 2

♣ K 6 5

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥9
 done on his own.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's ♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when East takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4 3
 ♥ J 10 2
 ♦ Q J 10 9 8
 ♣ A J

♠ K 10 8

♥ 7

♦ A 7 5 3 2

♣ 8 5 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5

♥ K Q 9 6 3

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2

♥ A 8 5 4

♦ 4

♣ 7 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
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3 ♦	3 ♠	1 ♥	2 ♠
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4 ♥	Pass	4 ♣	Pass
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Dbl

All Pass

4 ♠ X by South

Lead: ♠ A

the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

South's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal North/South have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 6 3 2

♠ 10 6 4

♥ 6 4 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ A K J



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥3

1NT

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice. Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick, which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥ winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he cannot establish the ♠ winner.